

A17 Bionic chip, the same as the iPhone 15 Pro but with one less GPU core. With 8GB of RAM and 128GB of storage (expandable via fast USB 3), performance is top-notch. Whether it's gaming, creative workflows, or multitasking, the iPad Mini delivers. It breezes through tasks, and benchmarks reflect this superiority:

- It outperforms rivals like the OnePlus Pad 2 and Galaxy Tab S10 Ultra in Geekbench 6.
- In gaming, it consistently achieves 60 FPS at maximum settings on Genshin Impact, BGMI, and COD Mobile.

Thermals are well-managed too. Even after an hour-long gaming session, the device feels warm but never uncomfortably hot.

Apple Pencil Pro integration

The iPad Mini is fully compatible with the Apple Pencil Pro, which works flawlessly. The hover function, minimal latency, and added haptics make it a fantastic tool for artists and note-takers. One feature I loved? The pencil creates a digital shadow on the screen that adjusts based on whether you're using a pen or eraser. It's these small touches that showcase Apple's attention to detail.

While I'm not much of an artist myself, I can see this being a game-changer for creatives.

Portability and everyday use

The compact size is what truly sets the iPad Mini apart. I've been carrying it daily alongside my laptop and smartphone. It doubles as a Kindle, and I've been enjoying reading *Blindsight* by Peter Watts—a hard sci-fi novel featuring vampires and genetically enhanced humans exploring alien territory. The portability makes it an excellent companion for both work and leisure.

Another unexpected use case? Recording benchmark numbers while testing laptops. Its small size makes it incredibly convenient for quick tasks like note-taking or organizing data.

Media consumption and connectivity

For media consumption, the iPad Mini's speakers deliver good sound quality, and the display—though not OLED—is color-accurate and bright enough for most scenarios. However, under direct sunlight, it struggles, limiting outdoor usability.

Connectivity is a highlight. With Wi-Fi 6E, USB 3.0 (10GB/s transfer speeds), and eSIM support, Apple has ensured the Mini 7 keeps up with modern demands. The faster USB 3.0 port is a blessing for those who rely on external SSDs for storage, making the base 128GB variant a practical choice.

Battery Life

Battery performance is solid. In my testing, the iPad Mini lasted:

- 9 hours 42 minutes of web browsing.
- Around 9 hours of continuous video playback.

This easily covers a full day of heavy usage, whether you're working, gaming, or streaming content.

Gaming performance

Gaming on the iPad Mini is a treat. I tested three popular games:

1. **Genshin Impact:** Ran at maximum settings with smooth 60 FPS.
2. **BGMI:** Flawless gameplay at the highest graphics.
3. **COD Mobile:** No frame drops or stutters, even at peak settings.

The A17 chip ensures excellent performance while keeping the device cool, making it a fantastic option for mobile gamers.

Turning the iPad Mini into a PC

Apple has added functionality to extend the iPad Mini's capabilities. By connecting a Thunderbolt cable, pairing a USB-C mouse and keyboard, and using the improved file management system, the iPad Mini can double as a basic computer. While there are limitations—like the inability to install third-party apps or full file system access—it's a step in the right direction for those seeking versatility.

What could be better?

While the iPad Mini 7 has a lot going for it, it's not without flaws:

1. **Outdated Design:** The bezels feel like a relic, especially in 2024.
2. **Lack of Haptics:** Typing feels incomplete without the tactile feedback that Apple excels at on its iPhones.
3. **LCD Display:** An OLED screen would have elevated the media experience, particularly for streaming and gaming.
4. **Limited Brightness Outdoors:** At 500 nits, it struggles in direct sunlight.

Is the iPad Mini 7 for You?

The iPad Mini 7 is an impressive device that finds its sweet spot between a smartphone and a laptop. It's portable, powerful, and versatile. Whether you're using it for gaming, note-taking, or even as a secondary display, it excels. The new additions like faster USB 3, improved connectivity, and the A17 Bionic chip make it a jack of all trades.



However, its media experience is held back by the LCD screen, and the outdated design might be a dealbreaker for some. But if you can look past these drawbacks, the iPad Mini 7 is a multi-purpose device that punches well above its weight.

So, should you buy it? If you want a portable powerhouse that can handle everything from gaming to productivity, the iPad Mini 7 is worth considering. And if you want me to test its limits by ditching my laptop for a month, let me know! **d**